



1000-5 (Br Adj)

June 2024

BAC Membership

BRANCH ADVISORY COUNCIL
RECORD OF DECISIONS – MONDAY, 5 FEB 2024

RECORD OF ATTENDANCE

Position / Appointment	Rank & Name
Chair / Branch Leader	Brigadier-General Dave Yarker
Co-Chair / Branch Advisor (Outgoing)	Colonel John Roper
Co-Chair / Branch Advisor (In Coming)	Lieutenant-Colonel Steeve Lavoie
Member / Colonel Commandant	Brigadier-General(Retd) Josée Robidoux
Member / Branch Chief	Chief Warrant Officer Alex Arndt
Member / General Officer	Lieutenant-General Frances Allen (Regrets)
Member / General Officer	Brigadier-General Denis Boucher
Member / General Officer	Brigadier-General Pascal Godbout (Regrets)
Member / General Officer	Brigadier-General Walter Norquay
Member / General Officer	Brigadier-General Mark Parsons
Member / General Officer	Brigadier-General Justin Thibert
Member / Strategic A6	Colonel Guy Parisien
Member / Director Signals	Colonel Walter Jull
Member / Comd CFIOG	Colonel Corey Crosby
Member / Home Station Commandant	Lieutenant-Colonel Geneviève Audet
Member / Subaltern of the Year	Lieutenant Inga Hammer
Member / STA	Chief Warrant Officer Jeremie Doucet
Member / STA	Chief Warrant Officer Rob Sherman
Member / Home Station RSM	Chief Warrant Officer Jason McQuigge
Member / Member of the Year	Corporal Christian Glass (Regrets)
Secretariat / Branch Adjutant	Major Gavin Ellis
Guest / Primary Reserve Representative	Lieutenant-Colonel Lisa Smid
Guest / Primary Reserve Representative	Chief Warrant Officer Tracy-Ann Fisher
Guest / Home Station Staff Officer	Captain Simon Grant
Guest / Branch HR Supervisor	Sergeant Jean Knight
Guest / Branch Officer	Second Lieutenant Damon Severight

RECORD OF DISCUSSION

INTRODUCTORY REMARKS

1. The discussion opened with a brief introduction from the Branch Leader and a quick around table, at which point the Colonel Commandant was offered an opportunity to provide opening comments which were brief: "Let's get on with it!".

INCOMING BRANCH APPOINTMENTS & INCUMBENTS

2. The Branch Leader welcomed LCol Steeve Lavoie as the incoming Branch Advisor and bid farewell to Col John Roper, who served as the outgoing Advisor for the past three years. Gratitude was extended to Col Roper for his dedicated service during his tenure. Additionally, Lieutenant Inga Hammer (CFSCE) was recognized as the 2023 Subaltern of the Year winner, while Cpl Christian Glass (CFJSR) was acknowledged as the 2023 Members of the Year though he was deployed and unavailable for the meeting.

125TH ANNIVERSARY PLANNING DISCUSSION

3. The discussion on planning the 125th anniversary highlighted that the last major celebration occurred 15 years ago for the 110th anniversary. Participants considered leveraging past experiences, templates, SOPs, lessons learned, and available resources to streamline the planning process. Suggestions were made to engage the retired community and reservists in the planning efforts, with a proposal to establish a planning committee from the branch office. There was emphasis on the need for dedicated organizational efforts, suggesting the appointment of a director and team focused on finding resources and substantial activities, citing the RCAF 100th anniversary celebrations as a model.

4. The Branch Leader addressed overlapping anniversaries with the Medical Corps, proposing potential joint efforts and the formation of a committee including retired luminaries and reservists, co-chaired by members from both the Regular Force and Reserve. It was stressed the importance of having OPIs with sufficient rank to effectively engage with stakeholders. The Branch Leader concluded by emphasizing the need to find right members for the committee, suggesting the consideration of a Reserve Colonel and Reserve Major as a secretary to ensure effective coordination and execution of the anniversary plans.

C&E WEEK COA DISCUSSION

5. **Lesson's Learned:** The discussion emphasized prioritizing Branch needs over individual preferences to ensure collective success. Additionally, deliberations centered on considering both civilians and uniformed personnel as potential Mess Guests of Honour, particularly from institutions like RMC and the University of Toronto. It was proposed to split events between the National Capital Region (NCR) and Kingston to accommodate diverse member locations. Furthermore, strategies such as pre-selection were suggested to streamline event planning processes. Lastly, there was a call to engage the

retired community to mitigate conflicts and enhance retiree-centric events for the year 2024.

6. **COA 1 - NCR and Kingston Split** - COA 1 proposes a continuation of the approach adopted in the previous year, with events split between the National Capital Region (NCR) and Kingston. Emphasizing the necessity for deconfliction, concurrent events will require careful coordination, possibly under additional constraints imposed by event requests. The overarching theme for these events will center on reconstitution, reflecting the ongoing priorities of the Branch. Additionally, it is advised to maintain the relatively small scale of the Communication and Electronics (C&E) Week, predominantly through virtual platforms to ensure widespread participation and adherence to safety protocols.

7. **COA 2:** Carruthers splits events with a focus on socialization - suggests a division of events with a particular emphasis on fostering socialization within the Branch. Events would be front-loaded with Branch socialization and cultural activities, aiming to strengthen camaraderie and cohesion. Discussions revolved around the informality of an informal C&E Dinner, highlighting the importance of creating a relaxed atmosphere conducive to networking and relationship-building. The Meet and Greet session at the Vimy Officers' Mess (VOM) in Kingston garnered significant participation, writing down enthusiasm for such gatherings. Moreover, transitioning the Friday Mess Dinner saw an estimated increase in participation by 40-50 individuals, with no reported complaints regarding the change from Thursday to Friday, indicating a successful adaptation to the revised schedule.

8. **COA 3:** The discussion included proposals to allocate each event day to a specific element, such as Air Force Day or Army Day, for a focused thematic approach. The committee emphasized streamlining the planning of days and conferences, including the G6 and A6 conference, by involving participants from various lines for higher value outcomes. After a brief discussion it the COA was discounted as logistically not practical between the different elements

9. The C&E Branch leader highlighted the restrictive financial environment, prompting budget considerations. There was anticipation of including an operations component in upcoming events, involving Latvian and Ukrainian military personnel.

ACTION ITEM(s):

1. **Branch Office:** Review COAs and revise.
2. **Branch Office:** Create a list of the last 5 years' themes and distribute to the BAC membership.
3. **Branch Office:** Promote themes on social media platforms.
4. **BAC Membership:** Look for opportunities develop curated recordings of from our deployed members to show during C&E Week.

10. **BRANCH COMMUNICATION DISCUSSION**

- a. Branch office is working on an EC to hire a Public Affairs Office who will be able to contribute in the development of a new communications plan for the Branch.

11. **BRANCH FINANCIAL UPDATE**

- a. The Branch sought a budget of \$16,500 but received only \$15,000. To cover the shortfall, the Branch intends to utilize cash on hand and seek additional funding from sponsors. Despite the Branch's concerns, the C&E Foundation assured the C&E Branch that the financial situation was

satisfactory.

12. BRANCH HONOURS & RECOGNITION

- a. 3x Subaltern and 8x Member of the Year Commendations were sent to their respective units for presentation. Units were tasked with presentations, with a focus on increasing engagement with the Branch Commendation itself.
- b. C&E Branch Coins were designed by the Branch Chief and Branch Leader, with significant effort invested in their creation. It's requested that unit command teams push names to the Branch to recognize our members when members of the Branch Executive are visiting a unit.
- c. A call is put out for heritage awards. The award has not been handed out in some time and the Branch is eager to do so. Should a unit have any member who has done something, even at the unit level, it should be submitted to be recognized.

13. C&E MUSEUM UPDATE

- a. The C&E Museum provided comprehensive updates on several key areas. The status and roles of the museum staff were reviewed, ensuring clarity on current activities. A financial update covered the period up to December 2023, followed by a detailed financial overview for January 2024, highlighting the impacts of the ongoing strike. An update on the strike's developments and effects was also provided. Information was shared regarding the Directorate of History and Heritage's Material Distribution Framework (DHH MDF). Additionally, the museum outlined its upcoming events, offering a preview of future activities. Updates on volunteer involvement and opportunities were discussed, emphasizing their importance to the museum's operations. Finally, an open forum was held to address questions and concerns from attendees. Additional details are available in Annex A, slides 19-35.

14. ENVIRONMENTAL BRIEFS / SITREP:

- a. The Occupational Advisors and Senior Trade Advisors provided updates on all Branch Trades highlighting their current states and summarizing the details found in Annex A, slides 37-49. Highlight of the conversation included:
 - i. discussion on several trades being included in the incentive program;
 - ii. different strategies to increase the recruiting of each trade;
 - iii. the technical trades are struggling. Example: ATIS technicians are only able to come to parity with their establishment in 2043 at currently approved hiring levels within the Strategic Intake Plan (SIP), if the trade can make those levels, and
 - iv. additionally, a trades training throughput would need to be increased as the trade's SIP is increased.
- b. CFIOG has a new crest that properly represents a Level 3 organization, the previous crest used the design associated with a Level 2 organization with laurel leaves around it.
- c. CFIOG is standing up a Neural Diversity Affinity Group for the CAF to provide a safe space for these members to gather and look at challenges through a neural divergent lens.

- d. The Army Reserve provided several points:
 - i. CFSCE has several courses running this summer with ARes as a priority, specifically FSOC and BSOC;
 - ii. 2 Div has asked for 20% of their deployed positions be filled by ARes in addition to 28 reserve members already deployed around the world;
 - iii. Noted that the change of deployment dates impacts the availability of reserve members as they must coordinate amongst several stakeholders to deploy effectively.

15. **OPEN FORUM / ROUND TABLE / QUESTION PERIOD**

- a. The Branch opened selection of the Branch Advisor to the LCol level with several nomination reviewed and LCol Steeve Lavoie selected. It should be noted that using leveraging LCol for these important positions is feasible and can be entertained.
- b. Col Roper, the outgoing Branch Advisor, was thanked for his three years in the position and while also balancing his busy job of modernizing the NORAD communication systems.

16. **CLOSING REMARKS**

- a. The Colonel Commandant thanked everyone for the great conversation, challenged each member to address the points that were brought up within the meeting the extent possible within their positions.

Brigadier-General Dave Yarker, CD
Branch Leader

Colonel Steeve Lavoie, CD
Branch Advisor

Annex:

Annex A Branch Advisory Council Slide Deck